Adding & Subtracting Areas

Exam code: 0607

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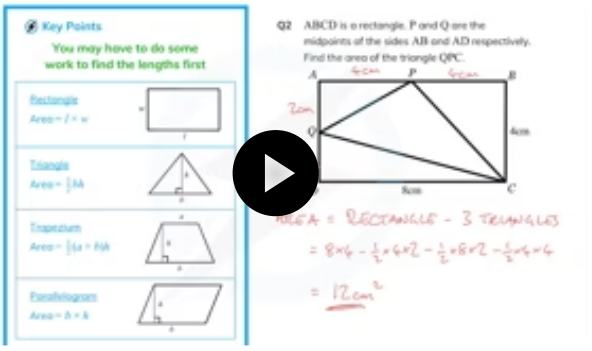

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Adding & subtracting areas

What is a compound shape?

- Sometimes you will have a shape that is **not a standard shape** such as a rectangle, triangle, trapezium etc.
  - These are often called **compound shapes**
  - We can **split** the non-standard shape into **standard shapes**

How do I find the area of a compound shape?

- **Split** the **compound** shape into **standard shapes**
- Find the **areas** of the **standard shapes**
- **Add** these areas together to find the area of the **compound shape**
- Occasionally it may be easier to **add an extra shape** to the diagram and **subtract the area** of the **extra shape** from the **new bigger shape**
  - For the shape below you might complete the rectangle by putting a triangle in the top right corner
  - The area of the **original shape** is the rectangle minus the triangle

Help me understand

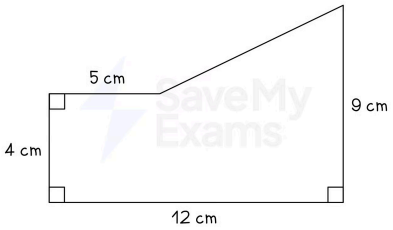
Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Take a moment to think about how to split up the shape into the easiest shapes possible – there will probably be more than one way to do it!

Worked Example

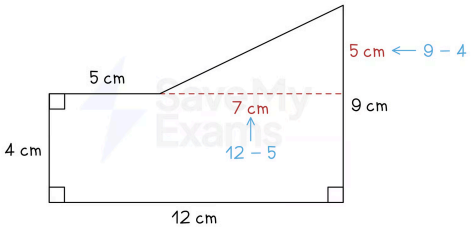
Find the area of the pentagon shown in the diagram below.



Answer:

Separate the diagram into two shapes that you are familiar with and know the area formulae for
This pentagon can easily be split into a rectangle and a triangle

Use the values given to find the length of the base and the height of the triangle and add these to the diagram.



The total area will be the area of the rectangle + the area of the triangle.

$$\text{Total area} = (12 \times 4) + \frac{1}{2}(7 \times 5)$$

$$= 48 + \frac{1}{2}(35)$$

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